



BACHELOR THESIS

RAW: a GitLab Integration within Moodle

Department

TIC

Program

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Specialization

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Context

LMS and VCS platforms are both essential in computer science education, but operate independently, leading to fragmented workflows.

Teachers

- Create repositories manually
- Configure repository permissions by hand
- Manage multiple platforms

Students

- Inconsistent workflows between courses
- Switch between LMS and VCS platforms
- Grades, deadlines, repositories in different places

Platforms Involved

Learning Management System (LMS)

- Centralizes course organization and documents
- Manages assignments, submissions, and grading
- Structured teaching environment

Version Control System (VCS)

- Manages source code and development workflows
- Enables collaboration through Git repositories
- Provides project management / DevOps tools



Moodle

Modular, open-source, institutionally established



GitLab

Self-hosting, data sovereignty

Specification

Objectives

- Assess existing solutions and APIs
- Design a modular architecture
- Implement, deploy, test and validate

Expected Result

- Extensible Moodle-GitLab integration
- Automated, centralized workflows
- Simple, open-source solution

Deliverables

- Report and planning
- Presentation and poster
- Plugins, documentation, tests, and infrastructure

Design Principles

Design a solution around 3 core principles

Automation

- Automate GitLab resource management
- Favor flexibility over rigid workflows

LMS-native

- Provide a unified workflow
- Central access point over fragmented platforms

Extensible Design

- Open-source allowing contributions
- Modular architecture for futur extensions

State of the Art

	Automation	Open source	LMS integration	VCS independent
GitHub Classroom (GitHub Inc.)	✓	●	✗	✗
Codio (Codio Inc.)	✓	✗	●	✗
Classroom 50 (Fifty Foundation)	✓	✓	✗	✗
RepoBee (KTH Royal Institute of Technology)	●	✓	✗	✓
Classmoji (Dartmouth College)	✓	✓	✓	●
RAW (HEIG-VD)	✓	✓	✓	●



Repository Assignment Workflow (RAW)

A Moodle-native, extensible, and open-source solution.

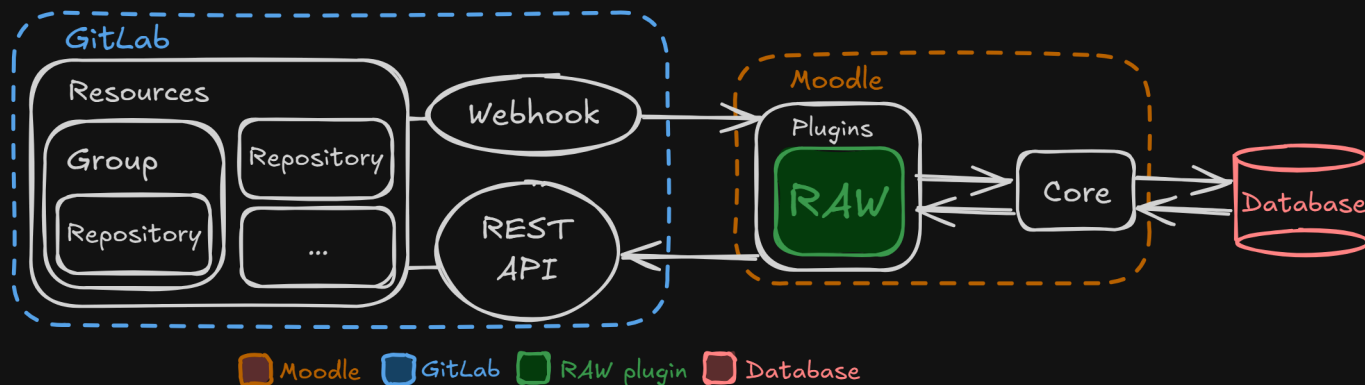


Figure 1. RAW architecture diagram

- Follows the 3 design principles defined previously
- Built using two Moodle plugins: **Custom Field, Activity Module**

Installation & Maintenance Footprint

INSTALLATION

2 Moodle plugins

- Upload plugins ZIP from Moodle administration
- or
- Copy plugins folders to
`mod/gitlab` and
`customfield/field/gitlab`

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External dependencies

Only Moodle's native APIs

MAINTENANCE

3 tables · activity, groups, memberships

2 custom fields · GitLab token, GitLab username

1 public endpoint · signed webhook, no Moodle authentication

ACCESS CONTROL BASED ON EXISTING MOODLE ROLES

Create activity

Manager · Editing teacher

Manage activity

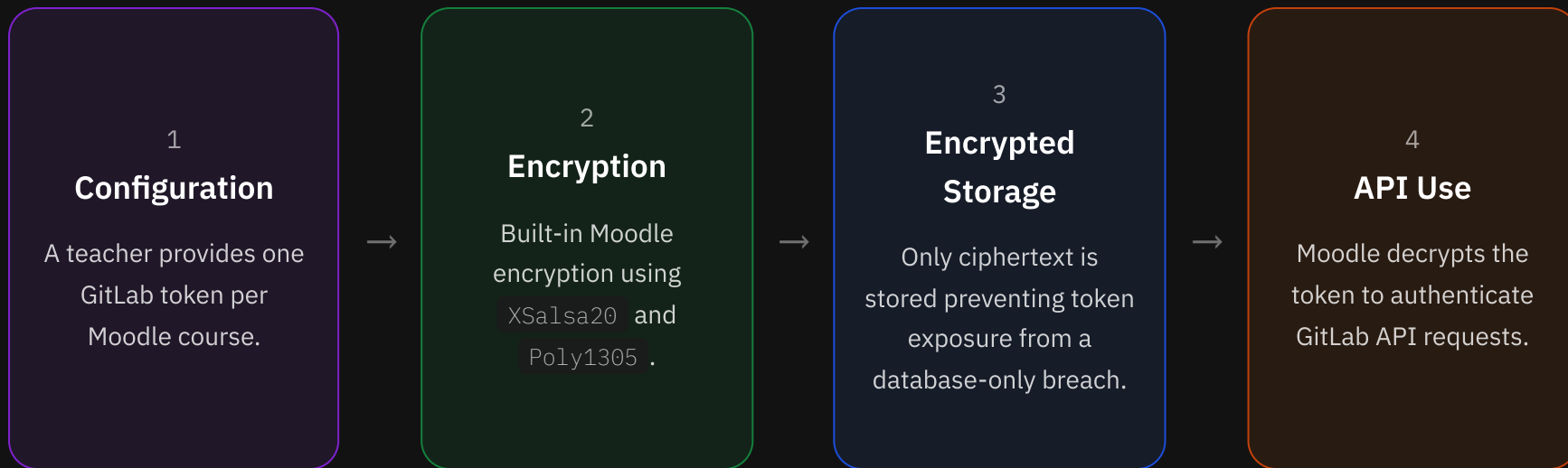
Manager · Editing teacher · Teacher

Join groups

Student

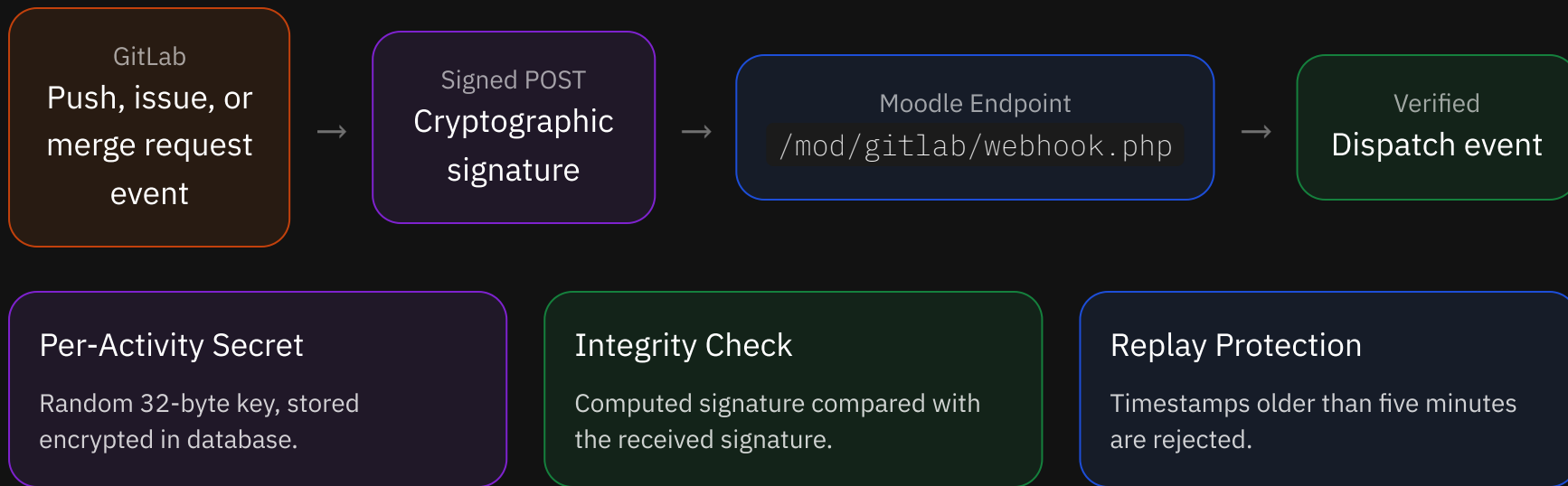
GitLab Tokens

Secure persistence of sensitive values with encryption



Webhooks

GitLab-to-Moodle synchronization through signed events



Only verified events can update templates, repositories, or submission status.



Demonstration

Features

Assignment Management

- RAW activity configuration
 - Due dates
 - Group capacity
 - Reviewers list
- Moodle calendar events and notifications
- Release solution access

User Workflows

- Teacher dashboard
 - Manage groups and members
 - Access template repository
 - Retrieve submissions
- Student interface
 - Create or join groups
 - Access repository

Features

GitLab Integration

- Automated repository provisioning
- Repository access and permission management
- Webhook synchronization
- Custom GitLab host support

Limitations and Future Work

Limitations

- Limited by GitLab's permission model
- Administrator access for plugin installation
- Manual Moodle–GitLab identity mapping

Future Work

- Improve error handling and user feedback
- Process long-running operations asynchronously
- Support additional Version Control Systems (VCS)
- Validate with representative users

Contributions

- Introduces a flexible, automated workflow
- Provides an extensible, open-source, Moodle-native integration
- Reduces manual coordination between LMS and VCS platforms
- Improves consistency and efficiency for instructors and students

